



Contemporary · strategy consultant and investor.

"Power is the potential to earn persistent returns."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Helmer set out to define precisely what creates durable competitive advantage — the 'power' to earn persistent differential returns.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

Drawing on decades of strategy practice and investing, he distilled durable advantage into seven distinct, exhaustive sources.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors 7 Powers and informs the Defensibility Matrix and Wrapper-vs-Moat Ladder in Unit 4.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

7 Powers operationalises as testing a business for each specific power rather than invoking a vague 'moat'.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

Identifying and building a power is harder in practice than classifying one, and the framework is descriptive rather than predictive.

ENDURING IMPACT

7 Powers has become a widely used strategy reference among founders and investors for analysing defensibility.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 4)

Jyh-An Lee et al. · Giant 16

Peter Thiel · Giant 18

Lawrence Lessig · Giant 19

Andrei Hagiu & Julian Wright · Giant 20

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Helmer, H. (2016) 7 Powers: The Foundations of Business Strategy. Deep Strategy.

Porter, M.E. (1980) Competitive Strategy. New York: Free Press.